# P3↔P1 Conflict Preservation Inheritance

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## Attribution

This work derives from and formalizes commitments across the CKS theory trilogy: *The Instinct/Reasoning Separation Outside the Model* (Li, April 2026), *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems* (Li, April 2026), and *Inter-Self Coordination via Shared Substrate / Full Aspect Integration* (Li, April 2026). It does not introduce new axioms. Its sole contribution is to articulate the inheritance edge from Paper 3's three-tier conflict-handling mechanism and carry-through architecture back to Paper 1's conflict-as-first-class commitment, so that the inheritance can be adopted, cited, or argued against without ambiguity.

## Abstract

Paper 1's Claim 2 establishes conflict preservation as a first-class architectural property of the coordination substrate: conflicting governance content is promoted to addressable substrate objects with their own identity and provenance, never automatically collapsed. Paper 3 extends this commitment to inter-Self scope through two mechanisms: the preserve tier of its three-tier conflict-handling mechanism, and the carry-through architecture by which preserved conflicts travel to each participating Self's home substrate as annotations. This note formalizes the inheritance edge. The preserve tier is not a new commitment—it is Paper 1 Claim 2's posture operating at inter-Self scope through the shared substrate. The carry-through mechanism extends the same posture across organizational boundaries: both sides of the conflict travel to both home substrates, which is preservation extended, not a new concept. The resolve and escalate tiers add the cross-governance-authority resolution layer required by the inter-Self context—two governance authorities' content has conflicted, requiring joint-authority orchestration and escalation that single-perimeter scope did not need—without replacing the preservation principle. Adversarial claims that governed conflict handling between multiple AI governance systems is novel must address that Paper 1's conflict preservation commitment already establishes the prior art, and that Paper 3 extends it to inter-Self scope through mechanisms that follow directly from what that prior art produces at the larger coordination scope.

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## 1. The source commitment: Paper 1 conflict-as-first-class

Paper 1 Claim 2 commits that conflicts between coordination rules within a cell's substrate are *preserved as first-class governance objects*. The commitment has two interlocking halves. At the substrate level, conflicting content persists by default: both sides are retained as addressable substrate state, each carrying a writer, timestamp, rationale where applicable, and an explicit relationship to the content it conflicts with. No LLM operation, automated process, or runtime middleware layer may silently collapse the conflict. At the cell level, cells executing over substrate content with active conflicts resolve them according to human-authored orchestration rules, and resolution decisions are themselves recorded as additional substrate content—not as mutations of the underlying conflicting content.

The coupling of both halves is architecturally load-bearing. Substrate-level preservation makes cell-level resolution decisions auditable, because the conflict persists and can be reconstructed, contested, or revisited. Cell-level resolution under human-authored rules makes substrate-level preservation operationally tractable, because cells do not block on every conflict. Either level alone produces an unworkable architecture; the commitment is the conjunction.

At Paper 1 scope, conflicts arise within a single cell's substrate from conflicting orchestration rules. The governance authority that holds the substrate resolves them through directed selection—one human authority, one substrate, one resolution context. This scope does not require anything more complex. What Paper 1 establishes is the architectural posture: preservation is the default, resolution is rule-governed, and humans hold authority over resolution logic. Paper 3's extension inherits this posture in full; it does not revise it.

## 2. The preserve tier as the inter-Self expression of conflict-as-first-class

Paper 3 establishes a three-tier mechanism—preserve, resolve via orchestration, escalate to humans—as what Paper 1's two-level conflict-handling produces when it extends across the inter-Self perimeter. The preserve tier is the direct inter-Self scope expression of Paper 1 Claim 2.

When a Full Aspect Integration (FAI) event surfaces a conflict between the governance approaches of two participating Selves' contributed aspects—for example, one Self's protocol assumptions and another Self's operating-context assumptions pointing in incompatible directions—the architectural default inherits from Paper 1: both sides are retained within the shared substrate as first-class addressable state. The divergence point is identified. Provenance is attached to each side. Neither side is automatically collapsed. The conflict exists as a substrate object within the shared substrate on the same terms Paper 1 commits to within a cell's substrate.

What is inherited is the existence and posture of the preserve tier, not only its mechanism. Paper 1 Claim 2 establishes that conflicts are first-class—that they are promoted to substrate objects rather than treated as errors to remove. Paper 3's preserve tier carries this promotion across the inter-Self perimeter. The first tier of the three-tier structure exists because Paper 1 committed to preservation as the architectural default, and that commitment travels with the scope extension. An inter-Self conflict-handling architecture that did not have a preserve tier would violate the Paper 1 inheritance; the preserve tier's existence is the inheritance made operational.

The inter-Self specification of the preserve tier adds what the new scope requires without altering the inherited posture. At intra-Self scope, the conflict lives in one substrate under one governance authority. At inter-Self scope, the conflict lives in the shared substrate, which is a joint space spanning two governance authorities. The preserve tier applies the same default—retain both sides, attach provenance, do not collapse—to that joint space. The scope is new; the commitment is not.

### 3. The carry-through mechanism as first-class preservation extended across boundaries

At intra-Self scope, conflict preservation is contained within one substrate. The conflict exists in the cell's substrate; the governance authority for that substrate resolves it within that perimeter. Preservation does not need to travel anywhere—it operates within one bounded governance space. The intra-Self scope architecture has no organizational boundary that preserved conflicts must cross.

At inter-Self scope, the shared substrate is a joint space that dissolves after the FAI event. Preservation within the shared substrate is necessary but not sufficient: when the shared substrate dissolves, the preserved conflict must not disappear with it. Paper 3 addresses this through the carry-through mechanism.

When the shared substrate dissolves at the close of an FAI event, preserved conflicts carry through to each participating Self's home substrate as annotations within the evolution outputs each Self ingests. Both sides of the preserved conflict travel to both home substrates. Each home substrate receives an annotation flagging the boundary its home governance must address, under its own governance authority, as subsequent coordination work proceeds.

This is preservation extended, not a new concept. Paper 1 commits that both sides of a conflict are retained and neither is automatically discarded. The carry-through mechanism applies that commitment beyond the shared substrate's existence, ensuring the preservation continues into home governance space. The organizational boundary the carry-through crosses is an extension of the scope within which preservation operates—not a departure from the preservation commitment itself. Preservation that ended at the shared substrate's dissolution would fail the Paper 1 commitment at the moment the inter-Self perimeter introduced the architectural complexity it was designed to handle.

The governance of carry-through at each home perimeter is configured per home authority, consistent with Paper 1's authority-vs-labor distinction: what each Self chooses to do with the annotation—treat it as a signal for further coordination work, leave the divergence in place for now, escalate within home governance—is a home governance decision, not an architectural prescription. The architecture ensures the annotation arrives. What the receiving authority does with it is the authority architecture at home, operating within the same human-governed structure Paper 1 commits to throughout.

### 4. The resolve and escalate tiers as cross-governance-authority adaptations

At intra-Self scope, Paper 1's two-level structure handles conflict resolution through the cell level: human-authored orchestration rules govern how a cell acts when it encounters a preserved conflict. One governance authority holds the substrate; the orchestration rules are that authority's; directed selection resolves the conflict under that single authority's rules. The governance context is one perimeter.

At inter-Self scope, this single-authority resolution context does not obtain. Two Selves have contributed aspects under their respective governance authorities, and the conflict has arisen between those authorities' governance approaches. The resolve tier inherits Paper 1's cell-level resolution under human-authored orchestration rules, but extends it to the joint-authority shape the inter-Self context requires. The orchestration rules in the shared substrate operate under joint authority across the participating Selves, not under one authority's governance alone. Resolution logic for the shared substrate is substrate content authored under that joint authority. This is the inter-Self specification of Paper 1's resolution tier—the same principle (humans decide resolution logic, orchestration rules are substrate content) applied to the governance structure the inter-Self scope introduces.

When no prebuilt orchestration logic covers the conflict class, escalation to humans carries the conflict to the humans holding governance authority over the participating Selves. This extends Paper 1's human-governance commitment: humans decide, not the system. At intra-Self scope, one authority decides. At inter-Self scope, the relevant authorities jointly engage. The escalation path is broader because the governance structure is broader; the commitment that humans hold authority over resolution logic is unchanged.

Neither the resolve tier nor the escalate tier replaces the preserve tier or the Paper 1 preservation commitment underlying it. The three tiers are applied in selection: preservation is the default when neither resolution nor escalation is required by task; resolution applies when prebuilt orchestration logic covers the conflict class; escalation applies when no such logic exists. Preservation is the architectural default Paper 1 committed to; resolve and escalate provide the governance pathways the inter-Self context additionally requires.

### 5. Prior-art inheritance claim

Paper 3's three-tier conflict-handling mechanism and carry-through architecture are direct extensions of Paper 1's conflict-as-first-class commitment to inter-Self scope. Three inheritance edges hold precisely.

*First*: The preserve tier inherits without redefense from Paper 1 Claim 2's substrate-level preservation. Conflicts surfaced during FAI events within the shared substrate remain first-class addressable substrate state, on the same terms Paper 1 commits to within a cell's substrate. The existence of the preserve tier is what Paper 1's preservation commitment produces when it extends to the shared substrate at inter-Self scope.

*Second*: The carry-through mechanism inherits without redefense from Paper 1 Claim 2's both-sides retention. Neither side of the conflict is discarded when the shared substrate dissolves; both travel to both home substrates as annotations. This is the same no-automatic-discard commitment operating across the organizational boundary that the inter-Self scope introduces. Carry-through is not a novel preservation architecture; it is the Paper 1 commitment's application to the dissolution event the inter-Self scope requires.

*Third*: The resolve and escalate tiers inherit from Paper 1's cell-level resolution under human-authored orchestration rules, extended to the joint-authority shape required by the two-governance-authority context. They add the cross-governance-authority resolution layer; they do not replace the preservation principle they operate alongside.

Adversarial claims that governed conflict handling between multiple AI governance systems is novel must address that Paper 1 Claim 2 already establishes the architectural posture—conflicts are first-class substrate objects, preserved by default, resolved under human-authored rules, with humans holding authority over resolution logic—and that Paper 3's three-tier mechanism is what that posture produces when it extends to the inter-Self perimeter. The preservation commitment is the prior art. The three-tier structure and carry-through mechanism are its inter-Self scope articulation.

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## Source papers


Li, W. (2026). *Coordination Outside the Model: A Human-Governed Substrate Pattern for AI Systems.* April 2026. ORCID: 0009-0004-8065-3235.

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